Research has shown that a writer's expectations of who will read their work, why they are writing and the situation they are in play a part in how they write. People choose things to say and how to say them depending on who is going to read it and what they want to achieve. Collin explains how things like audience purpose and situation affect the choices writers make (Collin). Also Black's research shows that college students might change the way they argue and persuade based on how they see their audience (Black). These ideas show that writing is not about what you want to say but also about how you share it with a certain person or group.

Most of the studies in this paper look at specific writing tasks like writing persuasive essays or doing school assignments. There is not much attention on how students change their writing in everyday situations and different kinds of communication. It is also interesting to look into whether students from areas of study make the same kinds of changes.

My research will look at how college students change their writing depending on the audience, the purpose and the situation. By using a survey given to students from subjects and schools I hope to find patterns in how they change their tone, the words they use, how formal they are and how much effort they put in. This will help create an understanding of how students deal with communication, in different situations.

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